

## Month-End Close Procedure

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This writing, mec-us-0001 at version v1.0, tells every business unit of Halden & Co. how a finished month is finalized and how its lines are labeled. Amounts are in USD. It applies to every business unit that keeps financial records on a monthly cycle. It has been in force since 2025-09-01, and no later version replaces it.

A close is the calendar month being finalized. A weekday is a day the offices are open for ordinary operations, leaving out weekends and company holidays. A seal is the moment that month's records become fixed. A ledger category is the label a transaction receives so it lands in the chart of accounts. The posting group is the small set of people who may type or release lines while the month is still open.

Before the seal, every transaction for that month is entered, checked, and tied out so the balances show a complete picture. Someone in the posting group confirms that everything already known has been recorded.

On the fifth weekday after a month turns over, the finance lead signs, and the records for that month are sealed. Nothing already written can be altered after that signature. The finance lead must sign before the seal is applied. Until that signature exists, lines can still be added or fixed. During those same days a team may find that a travel cost or an unpaid bill was given the wrong category. While the signature is still missing, a member of the posting group can correct the category and recheck the balance that moved. After the signature, that path is closed. The wrong category remains inside the sealed month, and the correcting entry is written only into the month in which someone noticed the mistake. The seal date, the finance lead's signature, and any wrong categories fixed before the signature are kept with the month's file. A note of anything deferred to the following month is kept beside them for audit. Avery Cole may sign in place of the finance lead when the finance lead is away, and that signature seals the month on the same terms. Temporary clerks supplied by Northstar Staffing may build the schedules that support the seal, yet they sit outside the posting group and must not type lines into the ledger.

A line typed by someone outside the posting group is undone. The finance lead either asks a member of that group to enter it again or leaves the matter until after the seal.

Only five badge numbers may add or amend lines while the month is still open: US-0001, US-0020, US-0984, US-9033, and US-8932. A line entered under any other badge is not allowed and is reversed when it is found.

Travel spending is recorded under general ledger code 6100-TRAVEL. Unpaid bills are recorded under general ledger code 2100-AP. The person who enters the line applies the category at the time of entry. Once the finance lead has signed, no adjustment and no new line is made in that month for any reason. A mistake found later is recorded in the month in which it is found.



Figure 1 shows the same order of work: lines are entered, then checked, then sealed. The drawing restates those three steps and does not add a rule.



*Figure 1. Enter, then review, then seal. Labels in the drawing repeat the prose.*